Demo Day - Product Requirements Document

Multi-Sport Scouting and Talent Development Platform

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1. Overview

Product: Demo Day digital platform (web + mobile app)

Purpose: Give every athlete - in football, basketball, and American football - an equal, connection-free path to be discovered by verified scouts, coaches, clubs, and programs, through open registration, geographically organized competition, and documented, data-informed evaluation.

Primary users:

- **Athletes** (majority minors) - register, get placed on teams, compete, get evaluated
- **Guardians** - provide consent, monitor participation, receive safeguarding communications
- **Scouts / coaches / clubs / programs** - observe athletes, record evaluations
- **Safeguarding officers** - vet adults, monitor event days, handle reports
- **Operations/competitions staff** - manage fixtures, verification, rankings
- **Sponsors** (indirect users) - view branding, receive reporting data

Sports covered at launch: Football (lead sport), Basketball (parallel pilot), American Football (relationship-building phase, pilot follows later).

2. Problem Statement

Talent identification currently depends on personal networks, informal recommendations, and in some cases bribery or favoritism - across all three sports, though the specific informal channel differs (club/academy ties in football, AAU/travel circuits in basketball, high-school/combine access in American football). Athletes without existing connections rarely get a genuine trial. Demo Day replaces this with a

registration-based, performance-driven, independently verified pathway.

3. Goals & Non-Goals

Goals

- Let any athlete self-register for their sport without a personal introduction
- Organize athletes fairly into geographically and positionally balanced teams
- Run verifiable matches/games/showcases that generate objective performance data
- Give verified scouts a transparent, documented environment to evaluate athletes
- Protect minors through consent, vetting, and safeguarding controls at every stage
- Produce auditable records that resist favoritism, duplicate accounts, and manipulation

Non-Goals (v1)

- Demo Day is not a governing body, league, or federation and will not claim affiliation, endorsement, or partnership with GFA, GBA, or the American football federation until formally granted
- Not a marketplace for direct athlete-to-scout financial transactions
- Not building broadcast/streaming infrastructure in Phase 1
- Not charging athletes or scouts to use the platform (sponsorship-funded model)

4. Core User Flows

4.1 Athlete Registration & Onboarding

- Create account, select sport (football / basketball / American football)
- Provide full name, DOB/age category, constituency/district/region, playing position, dominant hand/foot (if applicable), contact info, prior experience
- **If under 18:** parental/guardian identity confirmation and consent required before the account activates
- System assigns a unique athlete ID
- Identity, age category, and eligibility verification runs before the athlete can be placed on any team (prevents duplicate accounts and false information)

4.2 Geographic & Positional Team Formation

- Verified athletes are grouped by sport, then constituency/district/region
- Within a region, athletes are allocated to teams with attention to positional balance appropriate to the sport (e.g., football: goalkeepers/defenders/midfielders/wingers/forwards; basketball: guards/forwards/centers; American football: offense/defense/special teams)
- Remaining allocation beyond positional requirements is randomized by the system - not manually assignable - to prevent stacking
- Final rosters are locked before competition begins

4.3 Fixture Generation & Match/Game-Day Verification

- Platform auto-generates fixtures: pairings, dates, times, venues, match/game numbers, assigned officials
- Athletes check in via account/athlete ID on event day
- Officials confirm registered athletes match the people participating (anti-substitution-fraud control)
- A designated safeguarding officer must be present at every event day involving minors

4.4 Performance Recording & Scouting

- Authorized officials/analysts record sport-specific statistics (e.g., football: goals, assists, tackles, saves; basketball: points, rebounds, assists, shooting %; American football: passing yards, receptions, tackles, combine-style measurables) plus technical/tactical notes
- Verified scouts evaluate athletes against predetermined, sport-specific criteria
- Standout athletes receive multi-scout evaluation to reduce single-point-of-control risk
- All scout-athlete contact follows the Scout Code of Conduct (Section 7)

4.5 Ranking & Progression

- Match/game stats + scout evaluations + technical/tactical assessment + physical attributes + attitude/discipline are combined into a ranking within each sport

- Athletes meeting the required standard progress to Regional Demo Day → Elite Demo Day, or another higher-tier competition

Pathway summary: Account creation & guardian consent → Sport selection → Identity verification → Geographic allocation → Position assessment → Team formation → Fixture generation → Match/game-day verification → Competitive event → Performance data capture → Multi-scout assessment → Ranking → Elite selection → Club/academy/program or collegiate opportunity.

5. Functional Requirements

5.1 Registration & Identity

ID	Requirement
R1	System shall support account creation with sport selection at signup
R2	System shall capture full name, DOB/age category, region, position, contact info, and (where applicable) dominant hand/foot
R3	System shall require verified guardian identity and consent for any athlete under 18 before account activation
R4	System shall assign a unique, sport-agnostic athlete ID per person, with duplicate-account detection across sports and regions
R5	System shall support separate, revocable guardian consent specifically for media/image/video use, independent of registration consent

5.2 Team & Fixture Management

ID	Requirement
R6	System shall group verified athletes by sport, then region
R7	System shall enforce positional-balance rules per sport when forming teams
R8	System shall randomize non-positional allocation via an auditable algorithm (no manual override without a logged justification)
R9	System shall lock rosters at a defined cutoff before competition start
R10	System shall auto-generate fixtures (pairings, date/time, venue, officials) per sport's competition rules

5.3 Event-Day Verification & Safeguarding

ID	Requirement
R11	System shall support athlete check-in tied to athlete ID, with official confirmation of identity match
R12	System shall block an event day from being marked "active" unless a safeguarding officer is logged as present (for events involving minors)
R13	System shall log all scout-minor-family communications regarding trials/transfers/recruitment, visible to the safeguarding officer
R14	System shall provide an accessible, independent reporting channel to the Child Safeguarding Officer for any athlete, guardian, coach, or scout

5.4 Performance Data & Scouting

ID	Requirement
R15	System shall provide sport-specific statistic entry templates for officials/analysts
R16	System shall support multiple, independent scout evaluations per athlete against sport-specific criteria
R17	System shall restrict athlete access to only vetted, verified scouts (safeguarding vetting is a precondition, not optional)
R18	System shall combine stats, evaluations, and assessments into a per-sport ranking, with the ranking logic auditable/exportable

5.5 Media & Consent Enforcement

ID	Requirement
R19	System shall prevent publishing/sharing of any image or video of a minor athlete whose guardian withheld media consent

5.6 Sponsorship & Reporting

ID	Requirement
R20	System shall support sport-specific and phase-specific sponsor branding placements (kit, livestream, content tagging)
R21	System shall generate anonymized usage/reach data (registrations, event-day counts) exportable for sponsor and federation reporting

6. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Data protection:** Athlete data (ID documents, DOB, contact info, performance records) handled per Ghana's Data Protection Act; registration with the Data Protection Commission where required; defined retention policy.
- **Auditability:** Team allocation, scouting access, and ranking decisions must be logged and traceable - no silent manual overrides.
- **Multi-person authorization:** Key decision points (team allocation, scouting access, ranking) require more than one authorized role, per sport.
- **Availability:** Platform must support continuous, always-on operation between federation event cycles (a stated differentiator vs. periodic official programs).
- **Scalability:** Architecture must support scaling from single-region/single-sport pilot to multi-region, three-sport national operation without redesign.

7. Safeguarding Requirements (Product-Level)

Per the business plan's Section 14, these are treated as governance requirements, not optional features:

- No feature, growth target, or sponsorship opportunity may bypass safeguarding controls
- Every adult with direct minor contact (coach, scout, referee, staff, volunteer) must be vetted before system access is granted
- A central, periodically reviewed record of vetted/cleared adults is maintained across all three sports
- No unsupervised one-on-one scout/coach-minor contact outside official event days or sanctioned sessions
- Any financial offer/gift/incentive to a minor or family outside documented processes must trigger an immediate report and scout-verification revocation

8. Phased Rollout (Product Scope by Phase)

Phase	Timeline	Product Scope
Phase 1 - Pilot	Months 1-6	Single region; football (lead) + basketball (parallel); core registration, verification, team formation, fixtures, event-day check-in, safeguarding officer workflow live
Phase 2 - Regional Expansion	Months 7-12	Multi-region football + basketball; first American football pilot; sponsor reporting exports; scaled scout-vetting pipeline
Phase 3 - National/Elite	Year 2+	National football/basketball, regional American football; Regional & Elite Demo Day competition tiers; broadcast/streaming integration hooks

9. Risks Affecting Product Design

Risk	Product Implication
Duplicate/fraudulent accounts	Identity + DOB + phone verification, cross-sport duplicate detection (R4)
Unqualified/dishonest scouts	Mandatory vetting before access, multi-scout evaluation (R16, R17)
Favoritism in team/ranking decisions	Randomized allocation, auditable ranking logic, multi-person authorization (R8, R18)
Safeguarding failure	Consent architecture, vetting records, safeguarding-officer-gated event activation (R3, R12)
Overstated federation/sponsorship claims	Product must not auto-generate marketing claims of endorsement; sponsor/federation-facing exports should be clearly labeled as pilot/unconfirmed where applicable
Uneven investment across sports	Product architecture should treat sport as a first-class configurable dimension, not a football-only system with basketball/American football bolted on

10. Open Questions

- Confirm whether any existing platform in Ghana already offers open self-registration + structured scouting at constituency level (flagged as unvalidated in the business plan)
- Finalize named leads for Platform/Technology and Child Safeguarding Officer roles before defining detailed technical architecture
- Determine data-retention period for minors' performance and identity data, pending legal review